

Monthly Program Report: Ilorin Innovation Hub

Reporting Period: November 2025

Month Overview

In November, the Ilorin Innovation Hub continued to build on its mission of supporting innovators, entrepreneurs, and young talent across Kwara State. The Hub engaged over 2,000 participants in both physical and virtual sessions, providing practical learning, hands-on experience, and opportunities for networking and collaboration. Key highlights for the month included the Kwara AI Summit 2025, which convened over 1,500 stakeholders, the IIH Accelerator, which attracted 330 applications, the Kwara Digital Health Summit 2025, which brought together 159 participants, and the ongoing Piscine Bootcamp, engaging 159 learners in digital skills training. The month's activities reinforced IIH's role as a hub for learning, collaboration, and practical innovation, while strengthening connections between policymakers, innovators, and early-stage startups.

Program Overview

Program Goal

To cultivate a resilient and inclusive innovation ecosystem that empowers local talent, accelerates digital capacity, and promotes collaboration across sectors. In November, IIH focused on activating ecosystem pipelines, preparing emerging innovators for scale, and connecting stakeholders to knowledge, networks, and resources needed to develop sustainable ventures. Programs moved beyond foundational awareness to implementation and investment, linking innovators and early-stage startups with opportunities for mentorship, funding, and practical guidance.

Key Activities Conducted This Month:

- **Ilorin Innovation Challenge and Hackathon 2025:** To identify and support technology-driven solutions addressing locally relevant challenges through a structured innovation and hackathon process.
- **Pre-Incubation and Incubation Programme Residency:** To onboard and strengthen selected innovators and early-stage startups through residency

focused on product refinement, prototype development, and business model enhancement.

- **Builder's Path:** To equip entrepreneurs and emerging builders with practical insight on leveraging AI for clarity, problem-solving, and collaboration.
- **Mix & Mingle:** To foster intentional relationship-building through a themed community networking experience that encourages relaxed interaction, creativity, and collaboration among entrepreneurs, students, and innovators.
- **Digital Health Summit:** To generate actionable insights, stimulate demand for digital health solutions, showcase emerging innovations, and enable dialogue between key health actors to strengthen adoption in Kwara State.
- **Digital Health Pre-Summit:** To convene government, industry, and academia for collaboration and ecosystem activation toward improved digital health outcomes in Kwara.
- **Kwara AI Summit:** To convene ecosystem actors for collaboration, policy dialogue, and knowledge sharing on AI adoption and innovation.
- **Tech Talent Bootcamp/Piscine:** To onboard and prepare aspiring tech talents for an intensive four-week peer-driven learning experience.

Progress Against Schedule (Key Performance Indicators):

KPI	Target for [November]	Actual for [November]	Variance [November]	YTD Actual	Variance YTD
Ecosystem Development (CcHUB)	8	6	-2	37	N/A
Ecosystem Development (IIH)	1	1	0	3	-2
Talent Training (Future Africa)	N/A	1	N/A	3	N/A

% of Attendance at Virtual Event	33%	61%	+28%	816	N/A
% of Attendance at Physical Events	50%	62%	+12%	4,630	N/A
Women Participation	30%	N/A	N/A	487	N/A

Key Achievements by Program Managers

Co-Creation Hub (CchUB)

Role & Focus

Ecosystem Development & Capacity Development for Ecosystem Actors

Key Achievements This Month:

Ecosystem Development:

- **Builder's Path:** This virtual edition engaged 25 emerging builders and entrepreneurs in a practical discussion on how AI influences everyday decisions, information flow, and personal focus. Participants examined how to navigate digital distractions, apply value-driven decision-making frameworks, and balance human creativity with AI-enabled efficiency.
- **Mix & Mingle:** This edition brought together 110 community members, including participants from the ongoing Pre-Incubation and Incubation programme, for a relaxed networking session designed to strengthen relationships within the local startup community. Interactive activities and group challenges encouraged collaboration, open conversation, and peer connection, enabling attendees to build new relationships and deepen their sense of belonging within the ecosystem.

- **Digital Health Pre-Summit:** The pre-summit session was held ahead of the main event to support stakeholder alignment and early dialogue; the full activity report will be incorporated in next month's submission once final documentation is received from the implementing team (CcHUB).
- **Digital Health Summit:** The event took place during the month and brought together 159 participants; the full activity report will be incorporated in next month's submission once final documentation is received from the implementing team (CcHUB).

Enterprise Support:

- **Ilorin Innovation Challenge and Hackathon 2025:** The bootcamp brought together 27 teams (10 startups and 17 innovators) selected from over 500 applications to participate in an intensive capacity-building programme across the Innovation Challenge (Incubation) and Hackathon (Pre-Incubation) tracks. Participants engaged in structured sessions on human-centred design, prototype development, storytelling, and pitch delivery, enabling them to refine their ideas, build early prototypes, and articulate clearer value propositions. The programme included both team-specific and joint learning activities such as iteration sprints, mock pitch sessions, and expert reviews, culminating in a final pitch day to determine teams advancing into Incubation and Pre-Incubation. Ten ventures received ₦29 million in equity-free funding, while additional teams progressed into the knowledge track for continued support.
- **Pre-Incubation and Incubation Programme Residency:** The 5-day residency introduced 9 innovators and 5 startups into the Pre-Incubation and Incubation programmes, serving as an intensive onboarding phase to strengthen product development and venture preparedness. Across plenary sessions, hands-on workshops, mentorship engagements, and peer review activities, participants refined their problem statements, iterated prototypes, validated customer insights, and developed early go-to-market approaches. Sessions also covered storytelling, team culture, and investor expectations, culminating in a simulated demo day where teams presented refined concepts and received targeted feedback. By the end of the physical residency, participants had established clearer models, enhanced their pitch skills, and completed the requirements for progression into the full 3-month incubation pipeline.

Technical Training:

- **Animation Training:** The Animate Africa program continued in November, with ongoing weekly sessions for the 273 creatives in the cohort. Building on earlier modules, participants advanced their skills in storyboarding, scene development, movement and visualization.

Future Africa

Role & Focus

Talent Development, Acceleration & Demo Day

Key Achievements This Month:

Research

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Technical Training

- **Piscine:** The four-week bootcamp is currently engaging 159 learners across Ilorin Campus in an immersive, collaborative environment that introduces them to the Learn2Earn pedagogy and prepares them for the 24-month digital skills programme. Through guided activities, project cycles, and continuous feedback, participants are being equipped for the demands of the 24-month programme, while facilitators observe performance patterns to identify those best suited for progression into the full training pathway.

Enterprise Support:

- **Accelerator:** The IIH Accelerator application opened on 3 November 2025 and closed on 28 November 2025, following a one-week extension from the original 21 November deadline. A virtual Q&A session was held on 17 November 2025 to share insights, address questions, and guide applicants through the accelerator journey. Across the application period, a total of 330 applications were submitted and are currently under review.

Ilorin Innovation Hub (IIH)

Role & Focus

Grassroots Ecosystem Development & Engagement

Key Achievements This Month:

Ecosystem Development:

- **Kwara AI Summit 2025:** The summit brought together over 1,500 participants, including policymakers, researchers, investors, and young innovators, to drive

discussions on AI applications across eGovernment, agritech, education, and the creative industries. The two-day event featured 40+ speakers, a hackathon with 60+ entries (three teams received ₦300,000 each in seed support), and the launch of the AI-enabled government portal. Strategic discussions highlighted new policy directions, cross-border investment pathways, and capacity-building initiatives, positioning Kwara State as a growing hub for AI-driven innovation in Nigeria and beyond.

Gender Registration & Attendance Metrics

- Overall Registration: 3,311
- Monthly Physical Program Attendance: 2,019
 - Male Attendees: N/A
 - Female Attendees: N/A
- Monthly Virtual Program Attendance: 25
- Overall Monthly Program Attendance (Virtual + Physical): 2,044
- Registration to Attendance Ratio: approximately 2:1

Upcoming Activities & Next Steps

Planned Activities for Next Month

- **Co-Creation Hub (CcHUB):** Skills Swap Circle, Ecosystem Sync / Town Hall, Animation Training, Builder's Path, and End of the Year Mix & Mingle.
- **Future Africa:** Accelerator Application Review, Selection Committee Onboarding, Briefing, and Interview Scheduling.

Key Focus Areas for Next Month

- Ecosystem Development
- Talent Training Roundup
- Notifying Successful Accelerator Candidates